

Assignment - 1

Design of Conversational Experiences

Comparative Analysis of Bot Builders

Selected Bot Builders

Open-Source Bot Builder: BotUI

Commercial Bot Builder: FreshChat

Submitted by:

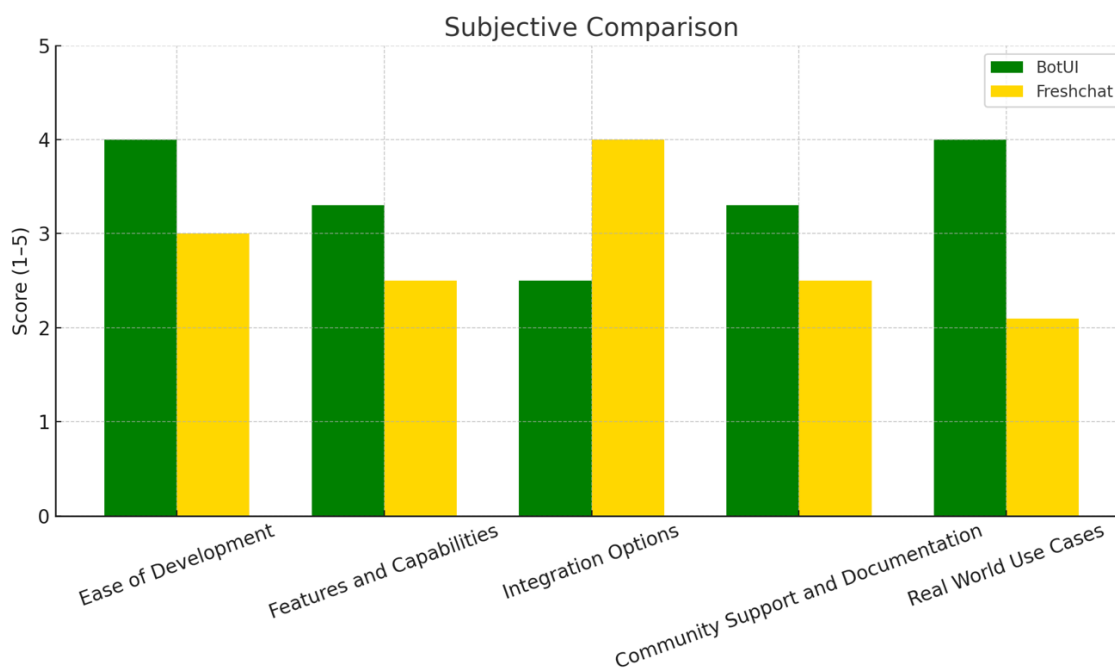
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Introduction:

This analysis offers a side-by-side evaluation of BotUI (an open-source conversational UI framework) and Freshchat (a commercial, customer messaging and engagement platform that also includes ease of development, features, integrations, community & documentation, and real-world usage).

Comparison Summary:



a) Ease of Development:

- BotUI which is a developer centric open-source conversational UI framework, that requires JavaScript knowledge. It provides clean UI framework the integration with NLP, backend needs to be done manually.

- Freshchat is a commercial customer and messaging platform which provides no-code flow builder, readily available templates, and AI bot options.

b) Features & Capabilities:

BotUI Highlights:

- It's a lightweight and modular JavaScript UI framework.
- Works with any NLP like Dialog flow, Rasa, OpenAI, etc.
- Fully customizable look & feel of bot.
- Minimal overhead for embedding in websites.

Freshchat Highlights:

- It's an omnichannel powered customer messaging (web, mobile, social).
- AI-powered chatbots and canned responses.
- Proactive campaigns and can also use for lead generation.
- Multilingual and analytics dashboards.

c) Integration Options:

- BotUI is an API-first, highly flexible framework which works with custom backends and major NLP frameworks. It requires developers to wire integrations manually.
- Freshchat is a native connector with Freshworks products, WhatsApp, Facebook Messenger, Slack, Shopify, HubSpot, Salesforce, etc. Out-of-the-box enterprise integrations.

d) Community Support & Documentation:

- BotUI is an open-source repository on GitHub, small but active developer community. Documentation is concise but limited. Great for researchers.

- Freshchat is a rich vendor documentation, onboarding programs, customer success teams, SLAs, case studies, and third-party resources.

e) Real-World Use Cases:

- BotUI can be used for custom chatbot prototypes, academic projects, startups wanting lightweight UIs, privacy-focused deployments with own backend.
- Freshchat can be used in Enterprise-grade customer support, lead generation, automated FAQs, e-commerce assistance, and multi-department support handling.

f) What Surprised Me / What I Learned:

- BotUI shines in simplicity and flexibility. It lets developers shape chatbot UIs without vendor lock-in, but it doesn't offer NLP, or enterprise features out-of-the-box. Freshchat, on the other hand, offers a polished, integrated ecosystem with AI, analytics, and omnichannel support, though it is closed-source and subscription-based.

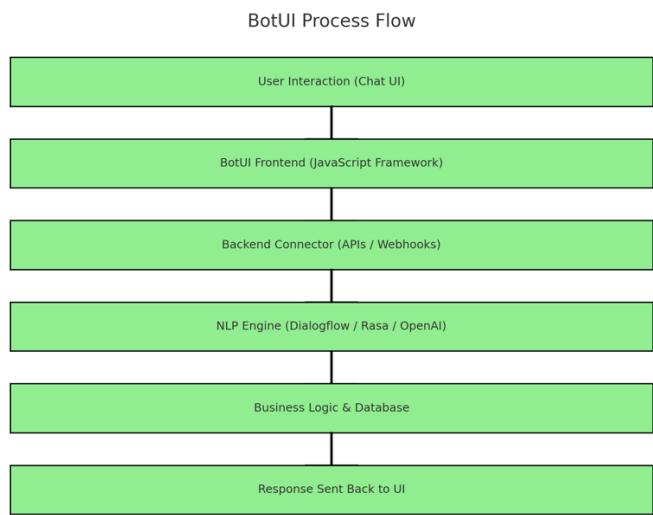
Quick Comparison Table:

Criteria	BotUI	Freshchat	Summary
Ease of development	JavaScript-based UI framework, dev-friendly, requires coding.	No-code/low-code setup, drag-and-drop flows, business-user friendly.	Freshchat – better for non-technical teams.

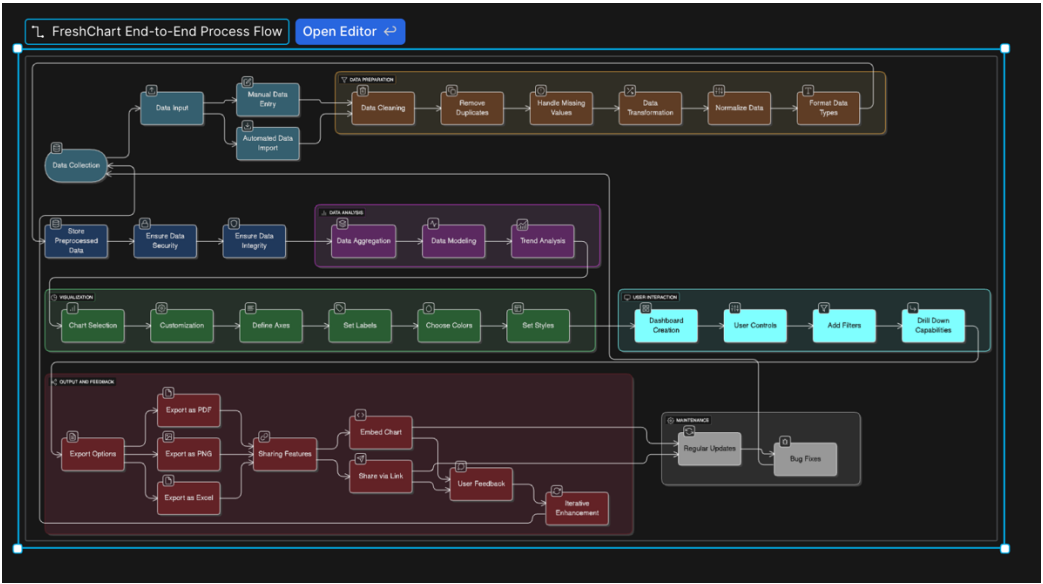
Features & Capabilities	Lightweight UI library, customizable frontend requires backend/NLP integration separately.	Full-featured CX suite with AI bots, campaigns, multilingual support, analytics.	Freshchat – broader feature set.
Integrations	Works with any backend (Dialog flow, Rasa, custom APIs), embeddable web widget.	Native integrations with Fresh works suite, CRM, WhatsApp, Facebook, Slack, APIs.	Freshchat – stronger enterprise connectors
Community & Docs	GitHub-driven, open source, community examples, limited official docs.	Extensive vendor docs, tutorials, onboarding, customer support SLAs.	Freshchat – more structured & enterprise-ready
Real-world Use	Best for developers needing custom UIs for chatbots, research/POCs, hobby projects.	Widely adopted in customer support, sales, marketing; scalable in production	Freshchat – proven deployments

Process flow diagram:

BotUI process flow:

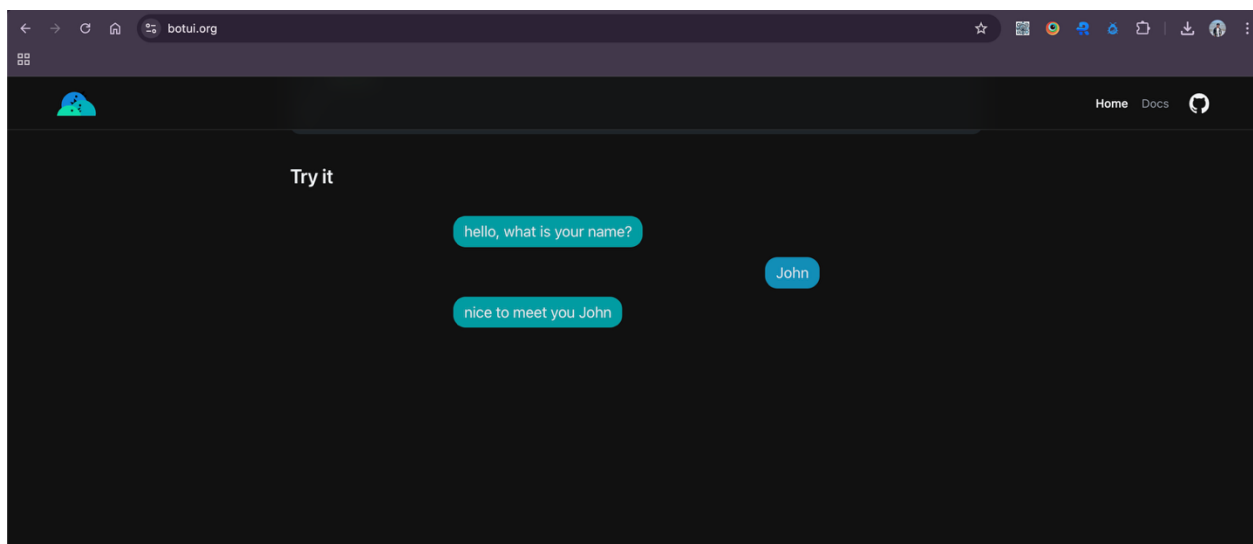
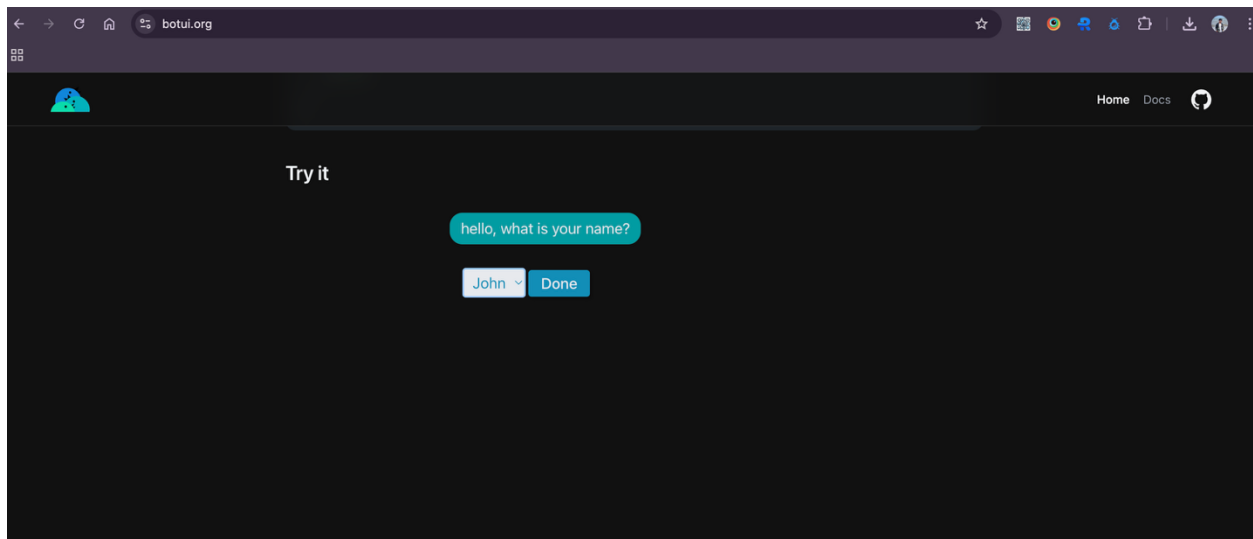


Freshchat process flow:

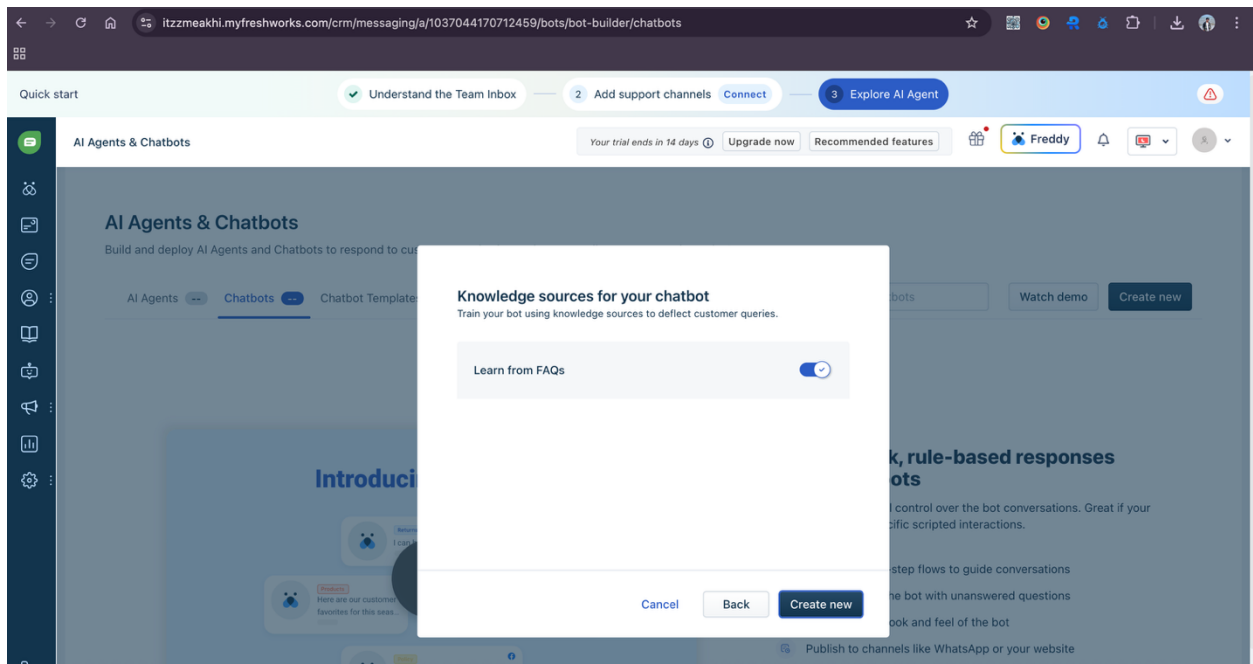
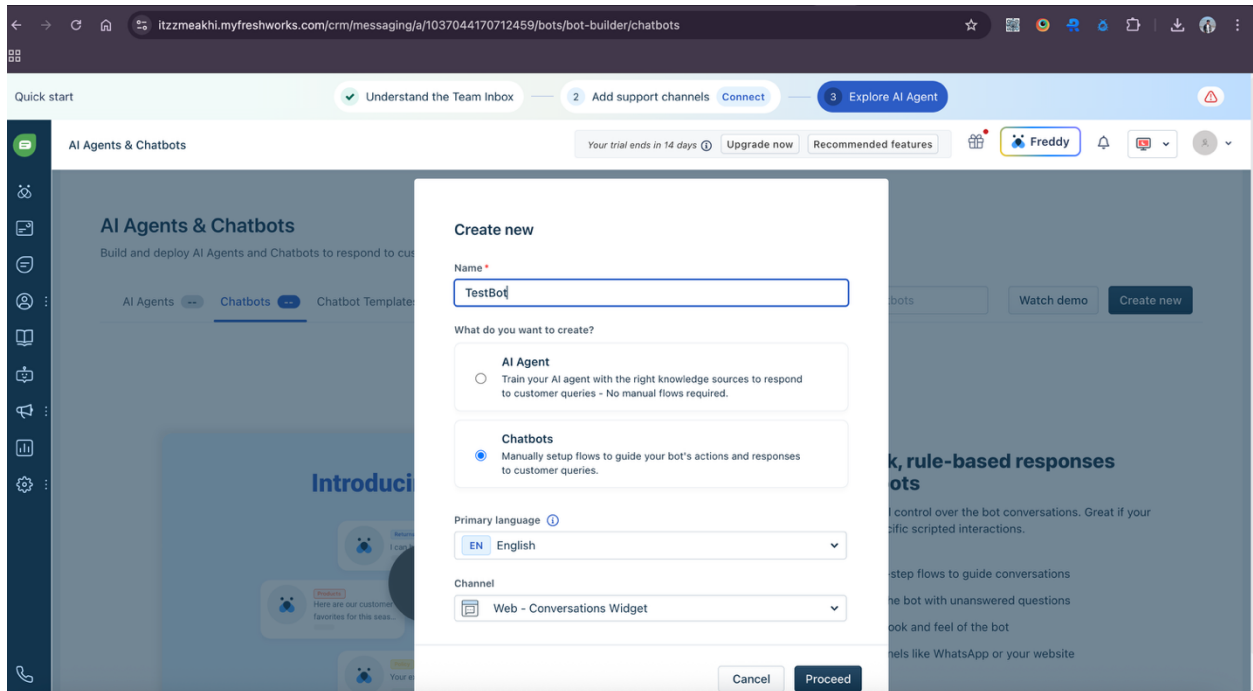


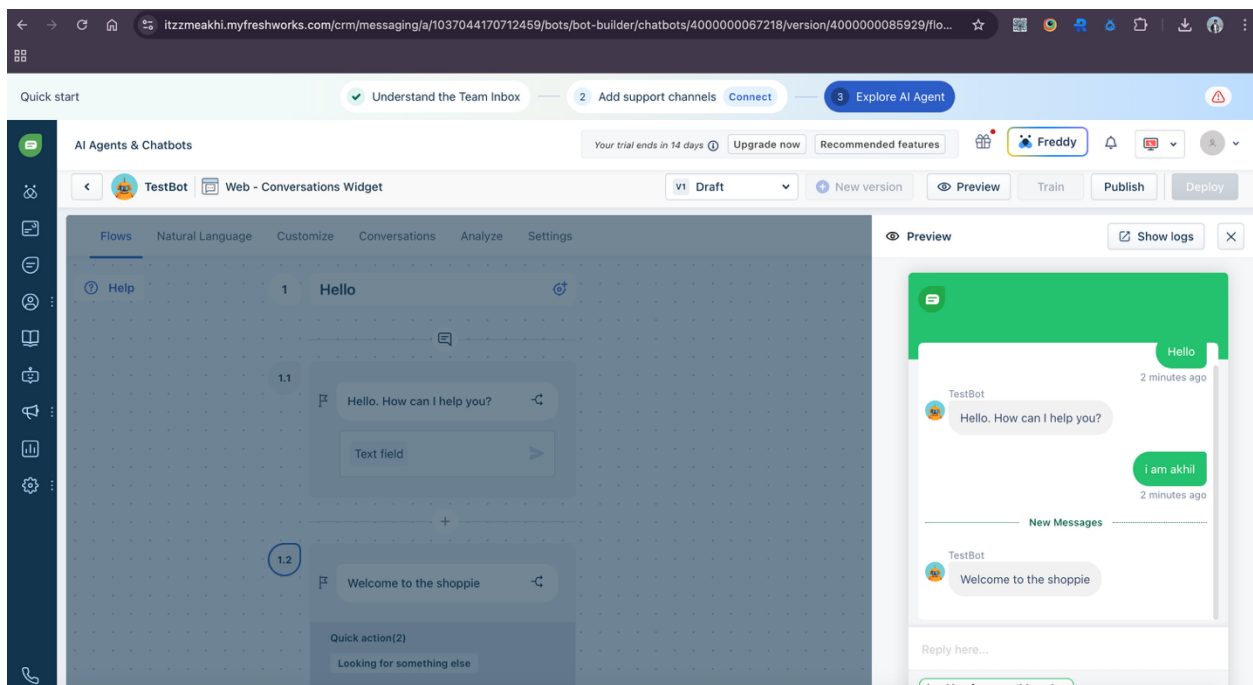
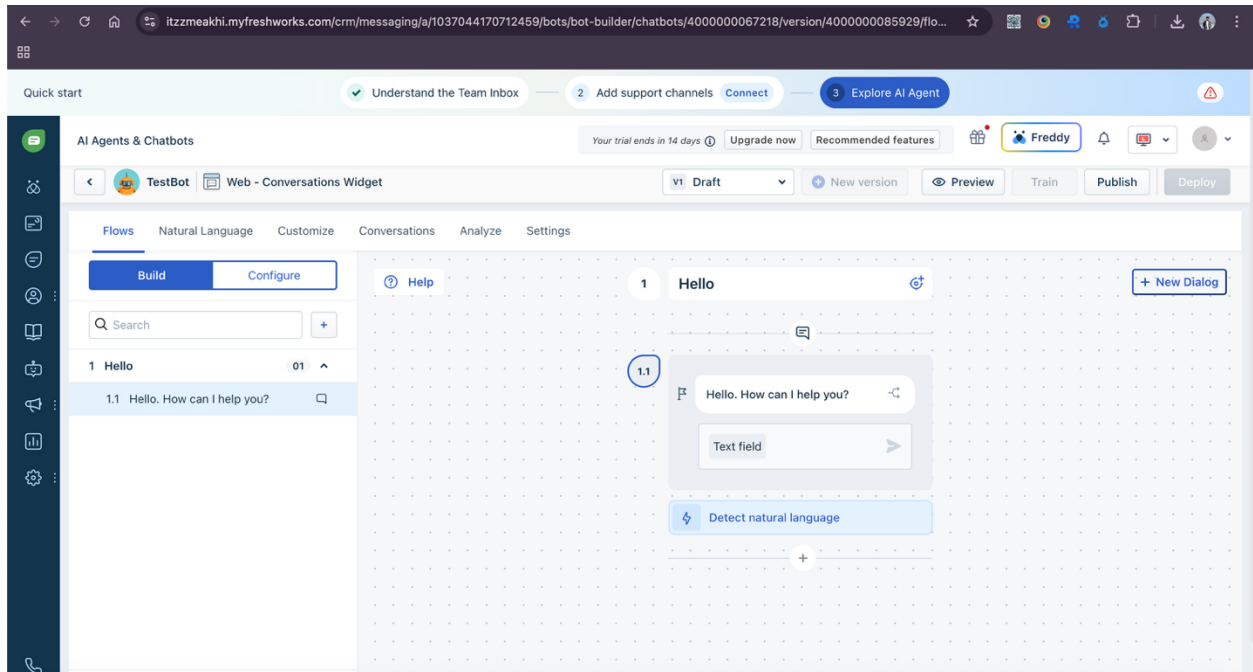
Real Bot Screenshots:

BotUI:



FreshChat:





Conclusion:

Strengths: BotUI is lightweight, flexible, developer-friendly, open-source. Freshchat is enterprise-ready, AI + analytics rich, no-code for business teams.

Weaknesses: BotUI requires significant backend setup and lacks enterprise polish. Freshchat can be costly and limits deep customization.

Recommendation: Choose BotUI if you need a customizable, open source chatbot UI framework to pair with your own backend/NLP. Choose Freshchat if you want a ready-to-use, business-friendly platform with strong integrations and proven enterprise deployments.